

PREMIUM

Pre-Departure Checklist

From visa/eVisa confirmed to landing in the United Kingdom

2-4 weeks before departure

- Confirm your visa status - check whether you have a digital eVisa (create/check your UKVI account) or a physical vignette, and that the details are correct
- Check your passport's remaining validity against your travel dates
- Confirm flights and accommodation
- Arrange travel insurance, including medical cover - the UK's NHS is not free for most visitors beyond emergency treatment
- Notify your bank/card providers of your travel dates and destination
- Organise any prescription medication, with the prescription/doctor's note, especially for controlled substances

The week before

- Save or print: passport photo page, visa/eVisa confirmation, flight itinerary, accommodation confirmation, and any invitation/sponsor letters
- Share your itinerary and emergency contacts with someone at home
- Check transit country requirements separately, if your route isn't direct
- Download offline maps and any useful apps for your destination cities

Day of travel

- Arrive at the airport with sufficient buffer time for an international departure
- Keep your passport and any printed documents in your hand luggage
- If you have an eVisa, make sure you can access it (e.g. via the UKVI account/app) in case it's requested

At the UK border

Arriving with a visa doesn't automatically grant entry - a Border Force officer makes the final decision at the border, and can ask questions consistent with your visa application. This is routine, not a sign of a problem.

- Be ready to briefly restate your purpose of visit and length of stay, consistent with your application

- Your permitted stay is generally up to 6 months from the date of entry for a Standard Visitor visa, regardless of the visa's overall validity period
- Keep a note of your entry date and the latest date you must leave by